

Strengthening financial futures for Black Americans

Helping financial professionals build culturally intelligent strategies that better understand and support clients' values, goals, and lived experiences

Building financial security starts with understanding the goals, values, and experiences that shape financial decision-making. Black and African American clients are striving to build lasting financial security, with a strong desire to create a legacy for future generations. They are often trying to balance competing priorities without the guidance of a financial professional. As a global company, Allianz is uniquely positioned to help financial professionals to deliver meaningful solutions to their clients with research-driven cultural insights and retirement risk-management strategies that are designed to strengthen long-term financial security.

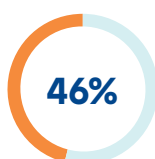
Future optimism – without a clear vision

Black and African Americans believe in their financial potential, but progress can stall without a plan

Confidence in achieving financial goals is strong among Black and African Americans, especially among younger generations and men. However, that optimism often lacks the foundation of a written strategy, leaving many without a clear roadmap to future stability.



70% say they feel confident about being able to financially support all the things they want to do in life.



Yet many lack a written financial plan, with notable gaps across both gender and generation. 46% of Black and African Americans do not have a written financial plan.

By generation

78% Millennials 59% Gen X 67% Boomers

By gender

61% Women 79% Men

By generation

27% Millennials 60% Gen X 67% Boomers

By gender

58% Women 35% Men

Allianz Center for the Future of Retirement® conducted the 2026 Annual Retirement Study in January 2026 with a nationally representative sample of 1,000 respondents age 25+ with an annual household income of \$50K+/\$75K+ (single/married) OR investable assets of \$150K+. The study also included an additional sample of respondents who identified as Black/African American (400 responses); Hispanic (407 responses); Asian/Asian American (356 responses).

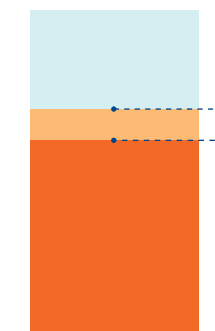
The Allianz Center for the Future of Retirement® produces insights and research as a part of Allianz Life Insurance Company of North America.

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Good intentions need a game plan

Retirement accounts are just a starting point for retirement planning. Turning savings into a comprehensive financial strategy requires going beyond the basics. Without a written financial plan or professional guidance, many may find it challenging to stay focused on their financial goals.

54% say that beyond contributing to a retirement account – like a 401(k), 403(b), or IRA – they're uncertain of what else they should be doing to prepare.



More than two-thirds of Black and African American respondents (69%) said saving for retirement is one of their top financial priorities.

Yet the majority (**60%**) say they are not saving as much as they would like to be.

When asked what's preventing them from saving as much as they would like for retirement, **these challenges rose to the top:**



Day-to-day expenses



Credit card debt



Housing costs



Health care

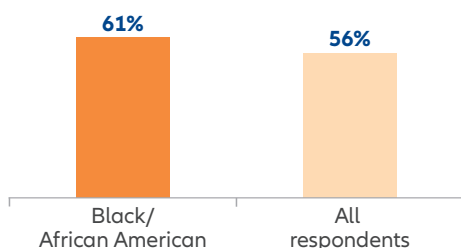


Saving for retirement is an important first step, but it's only one part of a larger financial picture. Financial professionals can help Black and African American clients understand how to create a strategy that can support their long-term financial goals and aspirations.

Legacy leads the way

For many Black Americans, the goal is to build wealth and pass it on

More than six in 10 Black and African Americans say they'd rather leave a financial legacy for loved ones than spend all of their money on themselves. **Legacy is a guiding priority**, rooted in caring for loved ones and a commitment to future generations.



61% of Black and African Americans would rather leave a financial legacy than spend all their money on themselves (vs. **56%** overall).

By generation

68% Millennials **60%** Gen X **45%** Boomers

This long-term mindset often coincides with potential caregiving responsibilities, including providing support to both children and aging parents – adding pressure to already complex financial decisions.



Make space in conversations for legacy planning. Millennials express the strongest desire to pass on wealth. This creates an opportunity for financial professionals to introduce strategies for legacy earlier in the client relationship when they can make the greatest impact.

Not prioritizing retirement puts financial futures at risk

Competing financial goals make it harder to focus on long-term targets

With multiple priorities to manage, making financial decisions often requires balancing what matters now with what matters next. Competing priorities can make long-term planning harder to maintain, even when the desire to build a fulfilling future remains strong.

58%

of Black and African American respondents say they're juggling so many financial goals, **it's hard to focus or prioritize**

What's holding you back from feeling empowered to retire on your own terms?



Not enough saved



Too much debt



Fear of financial unknown

Despite these challenges, many view retirement not as a destination, but as a new beginning and a chance to pursue passions.

View financial planning as a way to pursue the life they want, not just as a means to reach a monetary goal

69%

See retirement as a chance to chase new goals and dreams

69%

Think about retirement as a slow transition away from full-time work

59%



Grounding conversations in practical strategies to manage risk and balance short- and long-term needs can help keep plans on track. Incorporating retirement risk management strategies can reinforce stability and address concerns around uncertainty and income. This approach supports more balanced decisions, helping clients stay engaged in their retirement strategies while building greater confidence in their long-term financial future.

Guidance is valued, yet few have it in place

Many Black and African Americans recognize the importance of sound financial guidance. Still, far too few have a financial professional in their corner. This gap may reflect barriers like uncertainty about where to begin, or a lack of outreach from financial professionals who understand what matters to them.

Only 26% of Black/African Americans currently have a financial professional (33% men, 21% women).



And yet, the desire for support is clear: 90% say working with a financial professional would help ensure they can financially support everything they want to do in life.



Meaningful financial guidance begins with meaningful client understanding. Recognizing the values, priorities, and life experiences that influence a client's financial decisions can help financial professionals build trust and provide greater personalization to the planning process.

How a financial professional can help

Building trust through protection, transparency, and risk-management strategies that align short-term demands with long-term goals

Black and African American clients are likely to prioritize financial products that help protect against loss – especially as they focus on building sustainable wealth and providing for others. The fear of outliving retirement savings adds even more urgency to their desire for stability.



70% say they're more worried about outliving their money than dying.



70% would rather have financial products that protect against major losses – even if it means giving up bigger gains.

This mindset also reveals a deeper need for trust and transparency.

Many clients value professionals who go beyond creating a financial strategy and take time to educate and empower clients, and to align their plans with their personal values and long-term vision. When asked what would be the most valuable service a financial professional could provide, Black and African American respondents said:

1

Make sure I have enough money to last as long as I live

2

Organize my goals into a comprehensive plan

3

Help me build a foundation of knowledge to feel financially empowered



For clients who haven't worked with a financial professional before, the process can feel overwhelming or out of reach. By offering practical, transparent guidance and meeting clients where they are, financial professionals can build trust and help make long-term progress feel both approachable and achievable.

Beyond the numbers

As part of Allianz SE, a global company with operations in more than 70 countries, **Allianz Life has the cultural insights to help financial professionals meet the evolving needs of a multicultural client base.**

We understand that financial decisions are shaped by a wide range of goals, priorities, and life experiences. That's why we're proud to offer a range of retirement and risk management solutions through annuities and life insurance designed to support lasting financial security for all.

Our tools, insights, and resources can help financial professionals build trust, strengthen relationships, and create new opportunities for growth.

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